

Chocolates and Chips

Vrinda looked **fondly** at her Nana and Nani and said,

"Nanaji, why can't you extend your stay by just two days?"

Nanaji smiled. "We would have loved to be here on your birthday tomorrow but I have an important meeting at the office. I cannot miss it, my child."

"Don't worry, Vrinda," said Nani lovingly.

"Next year when you turn ten we will come over for a whole week."

"Now, Vrinda," said Nanaji, "smile and give me a tight hug."

Vrinda **rushed** forward and hugged her grandparents. Nani pulled out a big pink-wrapped box tied with a yellow ribbon.

"This is for you," she said, "but the right to give it lies with your mother."

"Surely not this," said Vrinda's dad. "You've already got her so many things!"

"This isn't much, beta — just toffees, chocolates and chips. All the things kids enjoy. But we leave it to you to decide how much she should have. We don't want to **indulge** her."

"Vrinda," said her mom, "your dad and I will decide how many toffees and chocolates you eat."

"You enjoy things more when taken in **moderation**," added Dad.

Vrinda **nodded absentmindedly**.

Wow, she thought, this box is a goldmine!

That night, when everyone was **asleep**, she **tiptoed** to the cupboard, unwrapped the box, and **bit** into a crunchy bar. She had one chocolate after another and three packets of **crisps** before bed.

The next morning, her parents were about to **wake** her **up** and wish her when they noticed the cupboard open and chocolates missing from the half-open box.

"How could Vrinda eat so many chocolates without our permission!" **exclaimed** her mom **furiously**.

"Relax," said Dad. "Instead of losing our cool, let's handle this wisely."



They woke Vrinda up with a box of **nutty** chocolates. "Did you enjoy the chocolates last night, Vrinda?" Mom asked.

Vrinda was puzzled. Why weren't they angry?

"Yes, I did. I love chocolates and toffees immensely!"

"Is it?" Dad said. "Then from now on, you'll have chocolates and chips for every meal!"

Vrinda **stared** in disbelief.

That morning she had a dark chocolate bar and milk for breakfast. Perfect! she thought. This is how breakfast should be!

At school, her tiffin had a packet of chips and a chewy chocolate. Her friends looked on **enviously** as she shared it **half-heartedly**.

Back from school, Vrinda was **famished**.

"You must be hungry, beta," said Mom. "Here's your lunch."

Vrinda looked at the plate of munchies and chocolate bars. She **glanced longingly at** her mom's plate of dal chawal.

That evening was her birthday celebration. The cake was a **yacht-shaped** chocolate one. There was pao bhaji and chole bhature. But all Vrinda got was a slice of chocolate cake and another chips packet.

When her friends left, she sat down to unwrap gifts.

"You'll love them," said her mother. "I told all your friends to get chocolates and chips."

Sure enough — all kinds of chocolates and chips in every flavour.

Vrinda began to sob.

"What happened, Vrinda?" Dad asked. "Didn't you like the gifts?"

"I'm sick of chocolates and chips," she cried. "I want normal food!"

Her parents smiled **affectionately** as she took a bite of chapatti.

"Yummy!" she **shrieked**. "I think I know what moderation means. Honestly, chapatti and subzi have never tasted better!"



Vocabulary

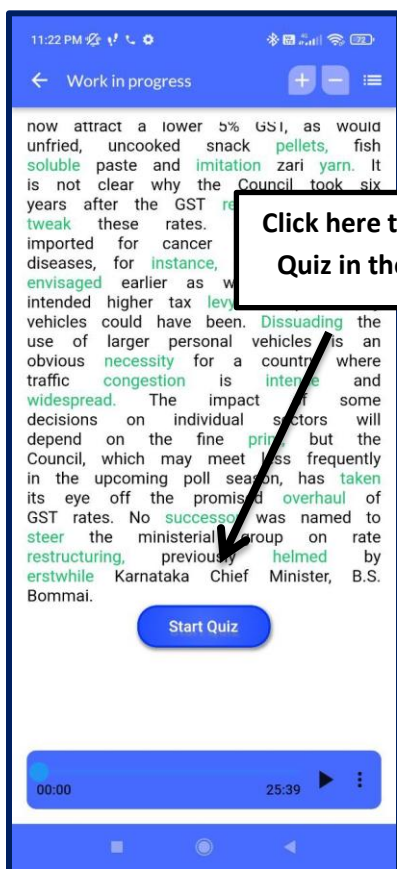
1. **Fondly** (at) (adverb) – affectionately, lovingly, warmly, tenderly, caringly – स्नेहपूर्वक
2. **Rush** (verb) – hurry, dash, race, run, speed – दौड़ना / जल्दी करना
3. **Indulge** (verb) – pamper, spoil, satisfy, gratify, coddle – लाड़-प्यार करना / मनमानी करने देना
4. **Moderation** (noun) – balance, restraint, control, temperance, limitation – संतुलन / संयम
5. **Nod** (verb) – signal, gesture, agree, bow, incline – सिर हिलाना (सहमति में)
6. **Absentmindedly** (adverb) – distractedly, inattentively, vaguely, carelessly, dreamily – अन्यमनस्क होकर
7. **Asleep** (adjective) – sleeping, unconscious, dozing, napping, resting – सोया हुआ
8. **Tiptoe** (verb) – creep, sneak, walk quietly, move silently, tread lightly – धीरे से चलना
9. **Bite** (verb) – chew, gnaw, munch, chomp, nibble – काटना
10. **Crisps** (noun) – chips, wafers, snacks, munchies, fries – कुरकुरे / चिप्स
11. **Wake up** (phrasal verb) – get up, arise, awaken, rouse, stir – जगना / उठना
12. **Exclaim** (verb) – shout, cry out, call out, declare, blurt – चिल्लाना / विस्मय से कहना
13. **Furiously** (adverb) – angrily, madly, violently, heatedly, fiercely – गुस्से से
14. **Nutty** (adjective) – containing nuts, nut-flavored, crunchy, nut-like, snacky – मेवायुक्त
15. **Stare** (verb) – gaze, look fixedly, gawk, glare, peer – घूरना
16. **Enviously** (adverb) – jealously, resentfully, begrudgingly, covetously, admiringly – ईर्ष्यापूर्वक
17. **Half-heartedly** (adverb) – reluctantly, unenthusiastically, indifferently, weakly, hesitantly – अनमनेपन से
18. **Famished** (adjective) – starving, hungry, ravenous, malnourished, empty – बहुत भूखा
19. **Glance** (at) (verb) – look quickly, peek, glimpse, scan, observe – एक नज़र डालना
20. **Longingly** (adverb) – wistfully, yearningly, desirously, pensively, eagerly – लालायित होकर
21. **Yacht-shaped** (adjective) – shaped like a yacht, boat-like, nautical-shaped, marine-styled, ship-formed – नौका के आकार का
22. **Affectionately** (adverb) – fondly, lovingly, warmly, tenderly, caringly – प्रेमपूर्वक

23. **Shriek** (verb) – scream, squeal, yell, cry out,

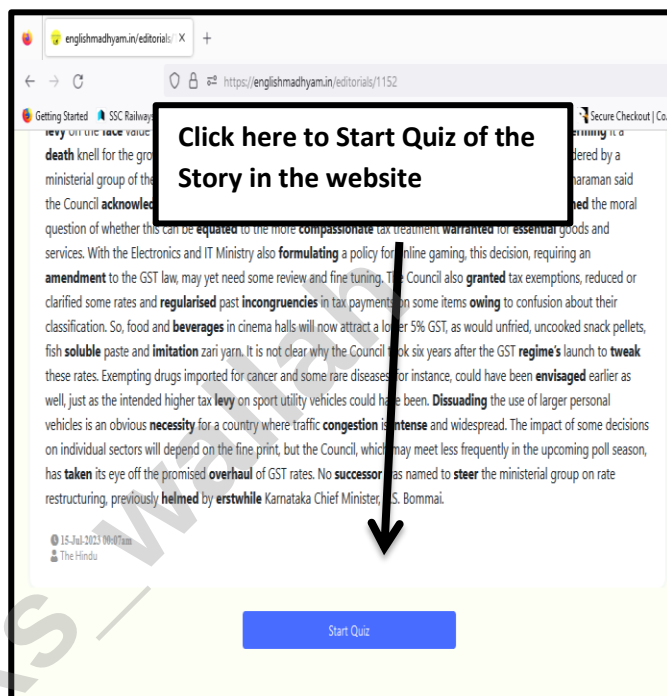
screech – चीखना / चिल्लाना

@mocks_wallah

Practice Exercise



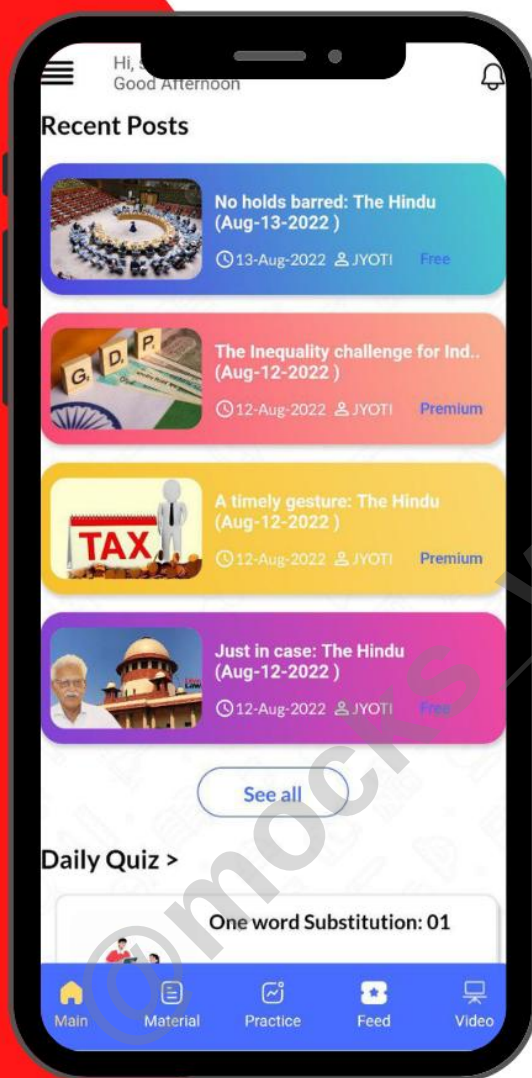
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